Climb27®

CLIMB23 TO CLIMB26

WHO WAS *THERE*

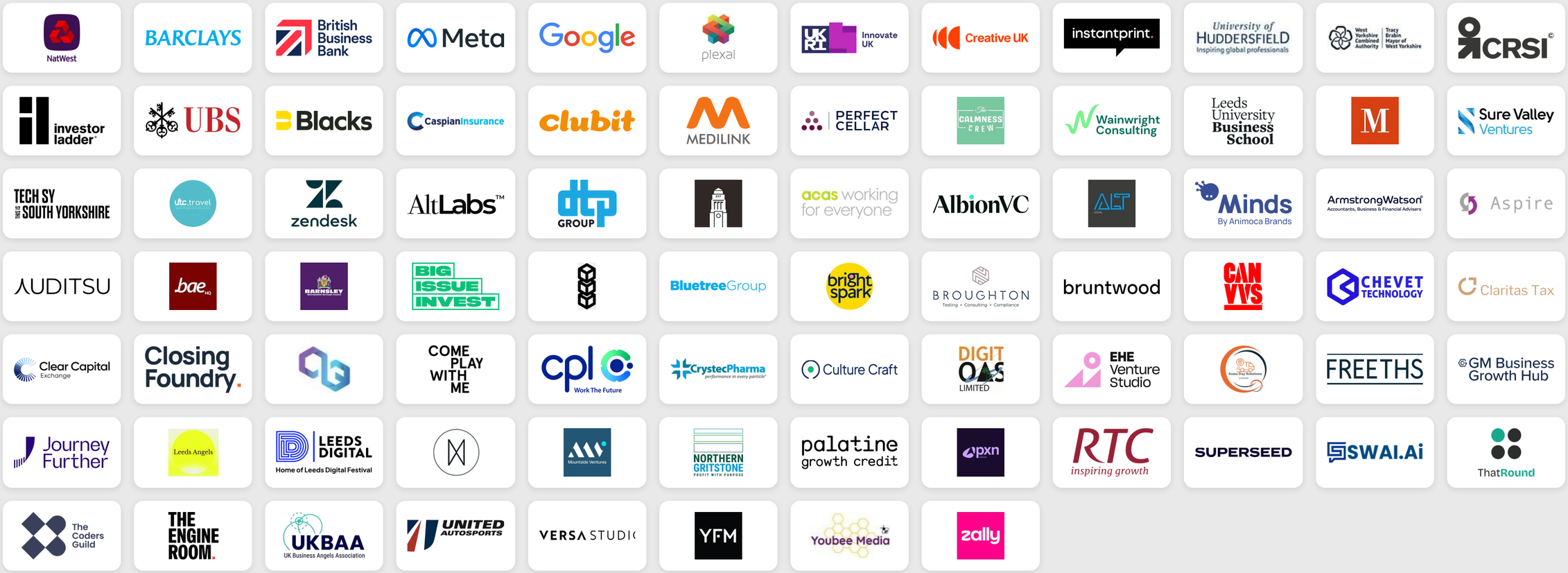
The partners, exhibitors, speakers and guests who made Climb23, Climb24, Climb25 and Climb26 The Festival of Business Growth, and what they said about it in their own words.



www.climb-uk.com

NAMES YOU *KNOW*

Banks, funds, universities, combined authorities, global tech companies and growing firms partnered, spoke and exhibited at ClimbUK.



PARTNERS AND EXHIBITORS

BACKED BY PARTNERS WHO *RETURN*

NatWest is backing Climb27, Climb28 and Climb29. Creative UK runs ClimbCreative, and instantprint is our official print partner.







- AnFiTest
- Barclays
- Blacks Solicitors LLP
- Blossom Training & Development
- British Business Bank
- C-Squared Consulting
- Caspian Insurance
- CaveManWF News
- City of York Council
- Clubit Group
- Cohen Gardner LLP
- CRSI
- Forward Balance
- Girls & Tech
- Health Innovation Yorkshire & Humber (Propel HealthTech)
- Ingenion Medical Limited
- instantprint
- Interactive Digital Systems Ltd
- Investor Ladder
- Jenny Garrett Global
- Just Verify
- Lead Talent Management Consultancy
- Loughborough University
- Medilink North of England Limited
- Mind Body Goals Ltd
- MSC R&D
- Myfolks
- NatWest Group
- Net-Zu
- North East Mayoral Strategic Authority
- NW Cybercom
- Palatine
- Perfect Cellar
- picknmixAI
- ProspHER
- Roller Girl Gang CIC
- Sucetas Technologies UK
- The Calmness Crew
- University of Huddersfield
- VenturePath
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- Wainwright Consulting
- West Yorkshire Combined Authority

CLIMB24 PARTNERS

Anticus Partners / Barclays Eagle Labs / Bobble Digital / Brightsolid / British Business Bank / Creative UK / Department for Business and Trade / EHE Ventures / Fourth Day / Hambro Perks / Huumans / Innovate UK Business Connect / Lancaster University / Leeds University Business School / Lloyds / Mishcon de Reya LLP / Page White / Parallax / Squire Patton Boggs / Startups Magazine / Sure Valley Ventures / Tech SY / UBS / UTC Travel / VeUP / Yuzu Agency / Zendesk

CLIMB24 EXHIBITORS

3D 360 / Alt Labs / Asclepius MedTech Ltd / Aspect International Group / BB Designs / Bellingham IT Ltd / Better Medicine UK Ltd / BIOStress / Bow Limited / Bowater Projects / Bradford Trident / Business in the Community / Campus Industries / CirKits Ltd / Closer Health / Coaching Untrained Leaders / Cox and Flight Financial Solutions Ltd / DARE Studios / Data Stream UK / Doza Consulting / DTP Group / E-Nano / EDI Accreditation / Fix your Future Ltd / Flying Duck Studio Lab / GigMeApp / Go Investment / Gowhoopies / Healthlinx UK Ltd / Herd Acoustics Limited / Highfield Gears and Machining / IDS Group / Impact Hub / Intercultural Roots for Public Health / IOU Theatre / Knarkz Solutions Limited / KwizzBit / Leeds Teaching Hospitals NHS Trust / M Canavan Consulting Ltd / Mind Body Goals Ltd / NatWest Social & Community Capital / Negotia Advisory / New Realities Lab / Nexus / NLC Health Ventures / nu.energy / Nymbel Ltd / Paxman Scalp Cooling / Perform Partners Ltd / Personalised Diagnostics Limited / Podmatic Ltd / Powerhouse Digital Limited / Predyktable / Qualia Academy / Qwillo / Remap Mental Fitness / Rhodes Music Group Ltd / SearchDATA Group / Seeai / Sendsorta Limited / Sferola Ltd / Sixty / Sticks & Glass / Studio Bokehgo / Syscada / The Monkey Puzzle Tree Ltd / The Other Person / The PIECES Project / The Rybec Group / This Is Interiors Ltd / UK Locations / University of Leeds / V&V Health Innovations Ltd / Videosign / VidPlate / Visiativ Solutions UK / West Yorkshire Combined Authority / Whirli / WRM Limited / Xerogrid / xigxag

CLIMB23 PARTNERS

Blacks Solicitors / British Business Bank / Channel 4 / CRSI / EHE Ventures / Fourth Day / Glean / Innovation City Belfast / Innovation SuperNetwork / Lewis Silkin / Mishcon de Reya / Partners& / Q5 Partners / River Capital / Sheffield City Council / Sky / South Yorkshire Mayoral Combined Authority / Strategic Coach / Sure Valley Ventures / UBS / University of Sheffield / University of Strathclyde / Variety, the Children's Charity / West Yorkshire Combined Authority / Write Business Results / xDesign

ON STAGE AT CLIMB26

SESSIONS WITH NAMES *YOU KNOW*

A few of the Climb26 sessions run with well-known companies.

Turning Attention into Action: Customer Acquisition with Meta

Scaleup Masterclass with Barclays, Google and Plexal

Google AI Build Session With Nocodelab.AI

From Prompt To Full Stack Prototype With Lovable and Nocodelab.AI

Scaling into the US for Consumer Brands: Lessons for B2C and D2C brands from Walmart Marketplace

Insight to Action - Cracking the US Market with Walmart Marketplace & Infinity Blue Group

TikTok Changed the Rules: The New Playbook for Business Growth

LinkedIn ROI: What's Working Right Now

Solve It in Bricks; LEGO Bricks

Innovation Competition Winners Showcase sponsored by Barclays

Redefining Possible: A Fireside Chat with Paralympic champion Jonnie Peacock, brought to us by NatWest



IN THEIR WORDS

WHAT PEOPLE SAID ABOUT *CLIMB26*

Partners, exhibitors, speakers and guests on Climb26, quoted word for word.

“We're delighted to partner with Climb26 and ClimbHealth as part of our continued commitment to supporting the next generation of innovators. Propel exists to help founders navigate the complexities of the NHS, to grow in confidence and then validate their innovations that will help to accelerate adoption.”

Dr Neville Young, Director of Enterprise & Innovation, Health Innovation Yorkshire & Humber (Propel HealthTech)

“Our team is proud to have attended and spoken at events at Climb UK this year, as it extended beyond Leeds for the first time and headed into the heartlands of the UK, such as Newcastle, Manchester, Leeds, and beyond. For us, this isn't just a calendar commitment. It's a reflection of how we've built our business.”

Ryan Sorby, Partner and Head of the North, Growth Credit, Palatine

“Working alongside ClimbUK enables us to extend this mission further connecting with a dynamic community of founders, business leaders, and forward-thinking organisations. This partnership is not simply about showcasing our capabilities; it is about engaging in meaningful dialogue, co-creating solutions, and strengthening the ecosystems that underpin long-term economic success.”

University of Huddersfield

“Partnering with ClimbUK allows instantprint to support that same audience in a different way, by backing events that invest in confidence, leadership and learning. Climb26 brings people together in person, and print plays a big role in shaping how that experience feels.”

instantprint

“ClimbUK gets this. Inclusion isn't corporate theatre. Regional innovation isn't secondary. And celebrating women who are building against the odds isn't charity, it's investment in an economy that actually works for everyone.”

Jenny Garrett Global

WHO SPOKE

CLIMB26 SPEAKERS AND *HOSTS*

Everyone who spoke at or hosted a Climb26 session, with the role and organisation they gave us.

Tayo Adebisi Founder / CEO, Tilz Prosperitas Limited / **Chris Allen** CEO & Co-Founder, Broughton Group / **Sarah Rose Anderson** Head of Music and Entertainment, BAND at Band Advisory Group Ltd / **Melvyn Ansell** European and Chartered UK Patent Attorney, Secerna LLP / **Tanya Arnold** Presenter, Tanya Arnold Media / **Franklin Asante** Coutts / **Luke Avon** Managing Director, Clear Capital Exchange / **Karim Bahou** Head of Innovation, Sister / **Julie Ball** Senior Client Partnerships Manager, Cpl Life Sciences / **Sarah Barber** / **Gordon Bateman** Chief Executive Officer, ClimbGroup / **Neil Bellamy** Head of Technology, Media, Telecoms (TMT), NatWest Group / **Diego Bermudez** Research and Impact Fellow, DICE Network+ / **Rebecca Bignold** / **Amy Bilton** Research Commercialisation Manager / **Sophie Dale Black** The Portfolio House / **Chris Borrett** Investment Director, Mercia Ventures / **Charlotte Boundy** Founder, Bright Spark PAs / **Tracy Brabin** / **Nick Bramley** CEO & Director of Impact, IMPACTUS Skills / **Hugo Brooks** Author and Founder, Magnetic North / **Carlton Brown** Academic, Consultant and Author, Aspire Consultancy / **James Brown** Senior Business Advisor, ACAS / **Abs Bulbuliya** Senior Investment Manager, British Business Bank / **Victoria Burnip** Co-Founder and CEO, Cognitive HealthTech Ltd / **Ethan Burniston** CEO, Burniston Media / **Alastair Carrington** / **Max Cawthra** Fractional Finance Director, Wainwright Consulting / **James Church** Author and Fundraising Partner, Investable Entrepreneur / **Mike Clarke** Partner, YFM Equity Partners LLP / **Emily Cloke** CEO, Creative UK / **David Coe** Co-Founder and CTO, Lutèo Medical / **Andy Coley** Principal Trainer / CEO, Leadership is a Skill / **Rita Collins** Regional Director - Corporate Banking, NatWest Group / **Dean Cook** Director - Business Growth and Global, Innovate UK / **Kate Cooper-Fay** CEO, Cooper-Fay Harris / **Sam Cooper-Gray** Chair, The Gender Index and Founder of The Women are Good Business Campaign, The Wisdom Studio Ltd / **Tim Craggs** Founder and CEO, Exciting Instruments / **Michael Crinnion** Founder and CEO, Mind Body Goals / **Jason Crispin** Founder & CEO, AUDITSU / **Rena Crossley** Destroyer of Dysfunctional Teams, Elevated Ltd / **Gary Crotaz** Executive Coach, Writer and Speaker / **David Crundall** / **Charlie Curson** Strategic Leadership Coach, Mandarin / **Chris Dale** Market Leader, Coutts / **Jordan Dargue** Co-Founder, Lifted Ventures / **Karen Davies** Head of Strategic Partnerships and Relationship, Equans Sci-Tech / **Graham Davies** Fund Principal, Mercia Ventures / **Ruth Davison** Director of Environment & Place, West Yorkshire Combined Authority / **Peter Denby** CEO, HyperFinity / **Nicky Dibben** Consultant, Invention Marketing / **Ian Donaghy** / **Mike Donohoe** Director & Head of Business Protection, Caspian Insurance / **Benjamin Drury** Advisor, Speaker and Author

IN THEIR WORDS

WHAT PEOPLE SAID ABOUT *CLIMB26*

“Yesterday I returned to attend ClimbUK. Invited by the energy field that is Gordon Bateman to speak on a panel about later stage funding and then I ran a more intimate bootcamp on VC Readiness and Red Flags for deeptech / lifescience / uni spinouts. The panel was nicely opinionated (the best kind), with great fellow panelists, [...]. We discussed the changes by round stage, growing pains for scaleups and the need to not go through the scaling and raising phase without great advisors in your corner (like VenturePath!). [...] Maybe its the sun or my nostalgic thoughts of a younger entrepreneurial me rushing around Leeds decades ago, fuelling my optimism, but there is no reason why we can't create more venture-backed scaleup successes from across the whole of the UK, and ClimbUK was a great indicator we have the right components to make this a reality.”

Ian Merricks, Founder, Proposition Lead, VenturePath

“ClimbUK - Climb26 rocked!!! Thank you so much. Fantastic festival promoting business growth, encouraging founders and investors and the whole ecosystem in the north of England. [...] Of course this event was an incredible opportunity for those of us selected to go, to develop our businesses and we are grabbing that with both hands, but also how fabulous to be show-casing the talent, drive, purpose and business success in the north. We are prepared to put the graft in. It was never more evident that innovation is not curtailed at the Watford Gap. Thank you Gordon Bateman and your team. You should be so proud.”

Louise Thompson, CEO & Founder, Myfolks

“It was so nice to be part of an event that really champions growing businesses in the UK and I've met some fantastic people this week who I hope to stay connected with.”

Rachel Kelly, Partnership Manager, Caspian Insurance

WHO SPOKE

Neil Dunlop Independent Consultant, Neil Dunlop Consulting / **Hannah Duraid** CEO and Founder, Gameshow All-Stars and The Great Escape Game / **Caroline Dyer** Founder, Heard Storytelling / **Iain Edwards** Investment Readiness Specialist, RTC North / **Abigail Elias** Co-Founder and CTO, Lutèo Medical / **Wayne Elliott** Associate Director of Commercial Enterprise, Newcastle upon Tyne Hospitals NHS Foundation Trust / **Tony Ereira** CEO, Come Play With Me / **Darren Evans** Managing Director, The Engine Room / **Mohamed Ezeldin** VP, Head of Labs, Animoca Brands / **Amin Fathi** CEO & Co-Founder, Innovarus / **Clair Flynn** Manager, People Partnering, Employment Hero / **Sarah Frankland** Head of Validation & Regulatory Affairs, Equans Sci-Tech / **Sharon Fuller** SVP Sports, OS Studios / **Jenny Garrett** CEO, Jenny Garrett Global / **Tom Gigg** Channel Account Manager, Inngot / **Milette Gillow** Co-founder & CEO, The Tech Bros / **Sarah Glanville** Strategic Partnerships Manager - UK & IE, Medilink North of England / **Daniel Glazer** London Office Managing Partner, Wilson Sonsini / **Parik Goswami** Director of Research and Innovation; Professor of Technical Textiles, University of Huddersfield / **Yvonne Grady** Director of Innovation and Digitisation, GM Business Growth Hub / **Andy Gray** Founder, BlockRocket.tech / **Jane Green** Health Tech Cluster Lead, West Yorkshire Combined Authority / **Ross Green** CEO, Embryo / **Bridget Greenwood** Director, The200bnClub / **James Haddleton** CEO, Haddletons / **Emma Haggas** Director, Rinew Legal / **Richard Hall** CEO / **Eve Hanks** CEO & Founder, MI:RNA / **Julian Hardy** CEO, Original Version / **Helen Hardy** CEO, FOUDYS / **Dean Hartley** Investor & Advisor, Chevet Technology / **Adam Hawley** / **Clair Heaviside** Chief Creative Officer, Embryo / **Sam Heilds** / **Volker Hirsch** Partner, Brainworks Ventures / **Yuan-Feng Ho** Medical Student, Zero Gravity / **Rebecca Holden** Head of Corporate, Blacks Solicitors LLP / **Rebecca Hopwood** Managing Director, YouBee Media Limited / **David Houghton** Founder, Common Ventures / **Edward Humphrey** CEO, CloudWize / **Nasar Hussain** Founder, ITC / **Hana Hussain** Investment Director, Big Issue Invest / **Chris Iveson** Founder and CEO, FourJaw Manufacturing Analytics Ltd / **Keith Jackson** Founder, 8-Q Limited / **John Jeffers** Strategic lead Growth Partnerships, ACAS / **Andrew Jenkins** Inspirational speaker, Strength in you Ltd / **Paul Johnson** Founder Chairman, Radar Healthcare / **Claire Johnson** Head of Leadership Development, Shrine London / **Andy Johnson** Strategy Director, Journey Further / **Tracey Johnson-Murphy** Director, TECH SY / **Matthew Jones** Managing Director, LimestoneGrey / **Bradley Jones** Founder & CEO, ThatRound Ltd / **Jonathan Keeling** Partner, Haatch / **Tamanna Keir** Legal Director, Hill Dickinson / **Tom Keithley** / **James Kinsella** CEO, Bluetree Group Ltd / **Gray Kueberuwa** CEO, Immunokey / **Malin Svanberg Larsson** Partner, Freeths / **Giovanna Laudisio** CEO, Naturbeads Ltd / **Guy Levine** Managing Director, Return On Digital Limited / **Jonathan Lewis** Corporate Finance Partner, Armstrong Watson / **Marisa Lloyd** Founder, The Agenda Lounge / **Dr Tony Lloyd** Consultant Neurodiversity Trainer & Coach, DrTonyLloyd.com / **Peter Lowes** Managing Director, Present Works

IN THEIR WORDS

WHAT PEOPLE SAID ABOUT *CLIMB26*

“Partnerships like this are essential in creating new opportunities for innovators to connect with the right people, from clinicians and health leaders to investors and industry partners. By working together, we can further strengthen the region's ecosystem and help bring transformative solutions to patients faster.”

Dr Neville Young, Director of Enterprise & Innovation, Health Innovation Yorkshire & Humber (Propel HealthTech)

“If there was one takeaway from Climb26, it's this: Growth isn't a straight line. Adapt. Build strong foundations. Diversify. Find great people. Keep moving. And perhaps most importantly: Remember - you're probably doing better than you think. Yesterday was the first time I had attended Climb. I found it useful, insightful, energising and now I have lots of ideas.....if you haven't been before I would check out next year's”

Louise Saw, Business Growth Manager, City of York Council

“What inspires us most about this partnership is the opportunity to play an active role in a movement that champions progress, ambition, and real-world impact. Together with ClimbUK, we aim to create spaces where knowledge meets opportunity.”

University of Huddersfield

“Every city has its own edge and nuances, and the tour has recognised that.”

Ryan Sorby, Partner and Head of the North, Growth Credit, Palatine

“A big pink stand at a business expo? You'd think you know who's stopping by. Wrong! We are absolutely DELIGHTED by how many female founders and leaders came to see us. The calibre of people building in this space is unreal. And just as many allies came to find us too! Diversifying tech only works if everyone's on board”

Girls & Tech

“instantprint are proud to be supporting ClimbUK for Climb26 and excited to see where this partnership goes next. It's about more than printing materials. It's about backing people who want to learn, grow and build something better.”

instantprint

“That coffee queue conversation became something bigger. A partnership. A commitment. A belief that talent is evenly distributed but opportunity isn't.”

Jenny Garrett Global

WHO SPOKE

James Lucas Founder Advisor / **Ellie MacDonald** / **Katie Mallinson** Managing Director, Loquiti Ltd / **Douglas Mancini** Senior Operating Partner, Closing Foundry / **Richard Marais** CEO, My T Bioscience / **Lou Matthews** Founder, Culture Craft / **Chloe Mayirou** Agency Partner, Meta / **Stuart Clarke MBE** Founder & Chair, Leeds Digital / **June Angelides MBE** Venture Partner, Samos Investments / **Simon McCoy** News Anchor & Broadcaster, Real McCoy Media Ltd / **Barrie McDermott** Director, Forward Pack / **Christina Colmer McHugh** Emotional Resilience Chief Officer, CCM Universal / **Ben McMullan** NatWest Group / **Jonny McNamara** / **Katherine Megson** Head of Innovation & Growth, Bruntwood SciTech / **Emma Mellor** Financial Controller, Mysing / **George Mensah** VC Investor, SVV (Sure Valley Ventures) / **Tim Mercer** CEO / **Ian Merricks** Proposition Lead, VenturePath / **Abbie Miladinovic** Strategic Lead - Growth and Sector Development, South Yorkshire Mayoral Combined Authority / **Stephanie Millward** / **Rahul Misra** Head of Investment, Creative UK / **Damian Mohammed** Founder and CEO, Northern Arc Partners / **Giles Moore** Regional Development Manager, PXN Group / **Sophia Kupse MSc** Senior Business Advisor, ACAS / **Ingrid Murray** Founder CEO, JamHUT / **Alex Murray** Founder & CEO, CANVVS / **Dahren Naidoo** Partner, Freeths / **Mark Northen** Head of Innovation Banking, Barclays Business Banking, Barclays Bank UK PLC / **Deborah Okenla** Founder, YSYS / **Helen Oldham** Co Founder, Lifted Ventures / **Zahida Omar** Director, Axis Consulting Group Ltd / **Christopher Owen** Director, Coliberate / **Amardeep Parmar** Cofounder, Bae HQ / **Yogan Patel** Head of Life Sciences/Pharma/MedTech, MHA Bakertilly Int / **Jashan Patel** Founder & CEO, Moonspring AI / **Louise Perkin** Partner, Solicitor (England and Wales), HLK / **Jason Perry** Director of Seller Success, Walmart Marketplace / **Helen Philippou** CEO, ClotProtect Therapeutics / **Mark Philmore** Client Director, MFL Insurance Group Ltd / **Robert Pieroni** Managing Director of Strategic Partnerships & Business Development, gener8tor / **Darren Pirie** Head of NatWest Group Accelerator & Strategic Partnerships, NatWest Accelerator / **Kat Plant** Client Relations Manager, IDS Group / **Erin Platts** Chief Executive Officer, Octopus Investments / **Wendy Popplewell** Executive Director - Core Services, Barnsley Metropolitan Borough Council / **Pat Porter** Founder, Myndtime Ltd / **Richard Price** CTO & Co-Founder, Pragmatic Semiconductor / **Jebran Raashed** Investment Manager, Octopus Ventures / **Rashmi Raju** International Manager, Medilink North of England / **Crispin Read** CEO, The Coders Guild / **Nic Redman** Voice coach & speaking director, Nic Redman Voice / **Alex Reed** Partner, Mountside Ventures / **Karl Rego** CEO & Founder / Co-Chairman, London Executive Advisors Ltd / Harvard Business Angels UK / **Arad Reisberg** Associate Pro Vice Chancellor (Social Mobility) / **Guy Remond** CEO, EHE Venture Studio / **Liz Rhodes** CEO, Art of Cloud / **Matt Richards** Founder & CEO, Sponza / **William Richmond-Coggan** Partner, Freeths / **Mark Roberts** Founder, Red Line Foundry / **Josh Robson** Chief Policy Officer, ScaleUp Institute / **Simone Roche** CEO, We Are Power / **Rachel Roche** Founder & CEO, PetPact

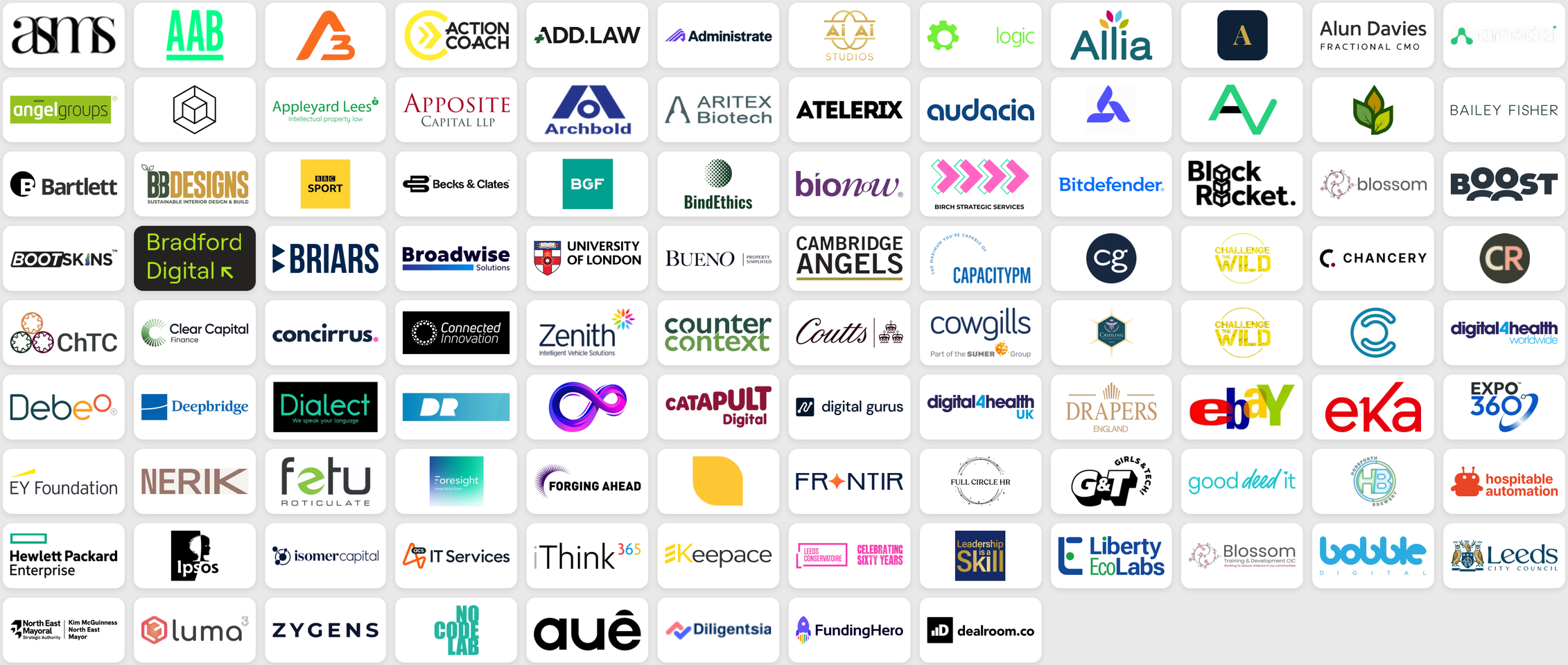
WHO SPOKE

Ipsita Roy Professor of Biomaterials, University of Sheffield / **Mehrdad Sadraei** Co-Founder and CEO, SWAI Ltd / **Steve Sankson** Relationship Management Lead, NatWest / **Nigel Sansom** Executive Chair, PinPoint Data Science / **Hazel Savage** Principal, Leeds Angels / **Dean Seddon** CEO, Maverrik Digital Services Ltd / **Gautam Sehgal** Head of Growth Solutions, Navigator Global at Santander UK Plc / **Lisa Shepherd** Founder and Director, The Biskery / **Jim Shirley** Founder, FundingHero / **Sara Simeone** CEO and Co-founder, Nocode.ai / **Nina Slingsby** CEO, OAHA / **Janine Smith** Greater Manchester Business Growth Hub Director, GM Business Growth Hub / **Christopher Ian Smith** Founder, EntrepreNERD Games / **Ryan Sorby** Partner - Head of North, Palatine Growth Credit / **Rory Southworth** Angel Manager, Fhunded Angels / **Bianca Spruit** Leadership Consultant & Coach, Sprout Coaching / **Justine Stalker** Partner, Claritas Tax / **Christiana Stewart-Lockhart** Director General, EIS Association / **Dahlia Stroud** Director, SBWD group / **Martin Sutton** Investor, TenX Ventures / **Rachel Swann** Founder, Rachel Swann Advisory Ltd / **Clare Sweeney** Founder, Keepace Consultancy / **Charles Talbot** Co-Founder, Closing Foundry / **Ashley Tate** Co-Founder, Sheffield Angels / **Mark Taylor** CEO, Automated Analytics / **Louis Taylor** CEO, British Business Bank / **Jen Taylor** Communications and Marketing Manager, NIHR Innovation Observatory / **Keiran Taylor** Corporate Finance and Banking Specialist, BPR Heaton Accountants / **Libbie Thomson** Community Manager, NatWest Group / **Paul Thorning** CEO, CrystecPharma / **Naomi Timperley** Co Founder, Tech North Advocates / **Patrick Trotter** Head of Innovation & Commercialisation, Medilink North of England / **Dave Tucker** CEO, Genio / **Richard Tunstall** Associate Professor of Enterprise, Leeds University Business School / **Daniel Vendyback** Managing Director - Angel Investor, Back Gardens Limited - Rally Yard Limited / **Charles Veys** CEO, FOTENIX / **Daniella Wainwright** Founder / Fractional CFO, Wainwright Consulting / **Phil Walker** Co-Founder, Mettryx Ltd / **Emma Walsh** Head of TMT within Barclays Business Banking / **Carly Walter** CEO Founder, MAGI / **Claire Ward** / **Jo Whight** CEO & Founder, Red Lotus Consultancy / **Sam White** Global Founder and CEO, Stella Insurance Australia / **Sam Whitehouse** CEO, Lightox / **Ed Whiting** Chief Executive, Leeds City Council / **Rich Williams** Broadcaster / **David Williams** Chief Operating Officer and Head of Community, Ideas Community / **Harry Williams** Technology Investor, Highland Europe / **Jez Willis** Musician, performer and educator, Utah Saints / **Tom Willshare** Co-Founder and CTO, Revela Health / **Farah Wilson** Chief Legal Officer, Nisien / **Phil Witcherley** Director of Economic Growth and Innovation, North East Mayoral Strategic Authority / **Troy Wood** AI Investor, EHE Ventures / **Andy Wood** Chair at WiSE / **Liam Wright** Co-Founder, Atlas Innovation Labs / **Oliver Yonchev** Cocreatd Limited / **Neville Young** Director of Enterprise and Innovation, Health Innovation Yorkshire & Humber / **Elizabeth Young** Investment Manager, PXN Group / **Saeed Younis** Partnerships Director & Senior Coach, Power For Women / **Nicole Zeno** Fractional Executive & Co-Host, What The Frac?

EVERYONE WHO CAME

IN THE ROOM AT *CLIMB26*

More of the organisations that came to Climb26.



EVERYONE WHO CAME

IN THE ROOM AT *CLIMB26*



IN THEIR WORDS

WHAT PEOPLE SAID ABOUT *CLIMB25*

Speakers, exhibitors and guests on Climb25, quoted word for word.

“Climb is all about building connections and creating opportunities. Being able to meet with the investment community and explore what we can do in our region to increase levels of business investment or seeing businesses we have supported continue to scale and take the next step makes this one of the key events of the year.”

Mitchell McCombe, Inclusive Economy Manager for Business Investment, West Yorkshire Combined Authority

“Congratulations, what a fantastic event! We thoroughly enjoyed it, and the initial feedback from all the NW CyberCom attendees, including senior leadership from Lancaster, has been overwhelmingly positive. There were lots of valuable connections made and even more conversations had! All of the NW CyberCom projects benefited greatly from being introduced to the business and investment world - quite a shift from the academic environment.”

Chris Wynne, Research Commercialisation Manager, NW Cybercom

“Being a part of Climb25 was truly an inspiring experience. My highlight was definitely meeting and networking with many incredible leaders but also speaking on a panel that was comfortable, natural, and professional all at the same time; it was truly a great experience. It really felt like a vibrant hub of innovation and connection, and the passion from everyone involved, especially the team, was palpable. It meant a lot to connect with so many driven individuals and contribute to such an important panel conversation around AI.”

Russell Bundy, Co-Founder & Chief Visionary Officer, Just Verify

“The energy, positivity and support in each and every room, whether presentation, workshop, socials in the square or networking was phenomenal - I saw perfect stranger connect through spending time eating their lunch together outside with us, then spend the rest of the day hanging out together. [...] I had unbelievable potential client opportunities through our workshop delivery and the quality people who scheduled networking introductions with me. Utterly loved it - thank you. Can we do it each quarter!?”

Daniella Wainwright, Founder, Wainwright Consulting

WHERE OUR SPEAKERS *CAME FROM*

100 Coaches Agency / 7 Percent Ventures / 8-Q Limited / ACAS / Achilles Information / Acid FC / Active Profile / Actmediaventures / Ada Ventures / Advance Digital Innovation / AI Tech UK / Aivantor / Albion VC / Alexander Bell CO / Alexander Whitley Dance Company / Alt Legal / AmarTi / Amilis / AMLo Biosciences / AmmarM Group / AND Digital / Animoca Brands / APIMS Limited / APM / Armstrong Watson / Art of Cloud / Aspire Consultancy / Atlas Innovation Labs / AUDITSU / Automated Analytics / Autonomo Technologies / Axis Consulting Group Ltd / Back Gardens Limited and Rally Yard Limited / Bae HQ / BAND at Band Advisory Group Ltd / Barclays Bank UK PLC / Barnsley Metropolitan Borough Council / BBC / Behavidence / Bella & Duke / Bethnal Green Ventures / Big Issue Invest / Big Society Capital / BindEthics and Quick Labs / Biorelate / BJSS / Black Seed / Black Valley / Blacks Solicitors LLP / Bloc Ventures / BlockRocket.tech / Bluetree Group Ltd / Born-Ugly / BPR Heaton Accountants / Bradford Academy / Brainworks Ventures / BrEpic / Bright Spark PAs / Brightsolid / British Business Bank / British Esports Federation / British Patient Capital / Broughton Group / Bruntwood SciTech / Burniston Media / BVCA / By P network / byDiffusion / Calls9 / CANVVS / Captur / Carbon Net Zero Industry Working Group / Caspian Insurance / Caterpillar Health / CCM Universal / CGHero / Chadwick Lawrence LLP / Channel 4 / Charlie Hedges Advisory / Chevet Technology / Chrouch Consulting / Claritas Tax / Clear Capital Exchange / Closing Foundry / ClotProtect Therapeutics / CloudWize / Cocreatd Limited / Code Computerlove / Cognassist / Cognitive HealthTech Ltd / Coincover / Coliberate / Come Play With Me / Common Ventures / Compare Ethics / Cooper-Fay Harris / Coutts / CovertSwarm / Cpl Life Sciences / CREATICITY / Creative UK / CrystecPharma / Cube International / Culture Craft / Culture Shift / CyberSmart / DAACI / DAZN / DeepBridge / Department for Business and Trade / DICE Network+ / Digital Oasis / Digital Poverty Alliance / Digital Sport North / Diverse & Equal / Dizplai / DrTonyLloyd.com / DTP Group / E2E Capital Ventures / Edge / Edge VC / EHE Venture Studio / EHE Ventures / EIS Association / Electric Peach / Elevated Ltd / Embryo / Employment Hero / EnterpriseAlumni / EntrepreNERD Games / Envestors / Equans Sci-Tech / Equity Gap / Evaro / Excelerator Partners

IN THEIR WORDS

WHAT PEOPLE SAID ABOUT *CLIMB25*

"Climb25 was such a thrilling and stimulating event for me. As a panelist during one of the Zally Zessions on Sales & Marketing, I was privileged to share the stage with some deep experts in go-to-market for start-up and scale-up companies. Apart from that, the networking opportunities were off the scale! I met so many founders, industry experts, functional specialists in technology, sales, marketing, funding and growth that I lost count. So many really valuable connections and insights that I was really buzzing and in fact hoarse from talking to so many wonderful people. I highly recommend the Climb event and I can't wait for next year."

Russell Palmer, Fractional CRO, Forward Balance

"As a purpose-driven entrepreneur, I am passionate about helping marginalised folks to find more confidence and connection within their lives, through roller skating. It was refreshing to have an audience of diverse thinkers at Climb25 - I have been met with incredulity that I can build such a business! I could go on, but the theme for Climb25 this year very much seemed to resonate around finding the courage to be your weird self, therefore your audience and niche, and looking at the social impact of how we show up."

Melissa Blackwood, Director, Roller Girl Gang CIC

"Climb25 served as a powerful reminder of the energy and ambition that exists in the North of England, and why it deserves a bigger stage. In a region often underrepresented in the national growth and investment conversation, Climb25 gave founders, investors, and innovators space to connect, collaborate, and be seen. [...] The conversations we had are exactly what this network needs. We left Leeds Dock with new ideas, new connections, and a renewed sense of momentum..."

Kat Plant, Client relations manager, Interactive Digital Systems Ltd

"ClimbUK is a fantastic event and it was definitely worth making the leap across the pond from Los Angeles to attend. There is an electric, entrepreneurial spirit spotlighted at the Climb Events and it was illuminative to attend and a pleasure to participate as a panelist."

Jeff B. Cohen, Esq., Entertainment Attorney, Cohen Gardner LLP

WHO SPOKE

Exciting Instruments / Exodus Technologies / Fagborun Limited / Fawkes Digital / Fearless Adventures / Fhunded Angels / Fleckerl Ventures / Flotilla / Forward Pack / FOTENIX / FOUDYS / FourJaw Manufacturing Analytics Ltd / Freeths / Friday Sundae / FundingHero / Future Greens / Game Republic / Gameshow All-Stars and The Great Escape Game / gener8tor / Generation UK & Ireland / Genio / Glean / Gleann Mor Natural Capital / GM Business Growth Hub / Goal Achieve Planner / GoatDrinks / GoJoe / GreenTech Gathering / GSG / Haatch / HACE / Haddletons / Halston / Health Innovation Yorkshire & Humber / Heard Storytelling / Heidrick & Struggles / HeyStephenHey / High Value Manufacturing Catapult / Highland Europe / Hill Dickinson / Histovery / HLK / Holdson / Housr / Hylo / HyperFinity / Hyperlight Ventures / i3 investing / Ideas Community / IDS Group / Immunokey / IMPACTUS Skills / Included VC / Inngot / Innovarus / Innovate UK / Innovate UK Business Connect / Innovate UK KTN / Innovation SuperNetwork / Inspirational Leads / Invention Marketing / Investable Entrepreneur / ITC / Ittybit / JamHUT / Jenny Garrett Global / Journey Further / Juniper Place / Just Add Water / Kalank / Keepace Consultancy / Kind Community / Kings Chambers / Kingston University / Lancaster University / Leadership is a Skill / Leeds Angels / Leeds City Council / Leeds Community Foundation / Leeds Digital / Leeds University Business School / Lewis Silkin / Life More Offline / Lifted Ventures / Lightox / LimestoneGrey / LIVE / Lloyds / Lloyds Bank / Lloyds Banking Group / LOANHOOD / London Executive Advisors Ltd / Harvard Business Angels UK / London Stock Exchange Group / Loquiti Ltd / Losonnante / Lutèo Medical / Lyons Consultancy / madeby.studio / MAGI / Magnetic North / Make Impact / Make It Wild / Male Allies UK / Manchester Angels / Manchester Metropolitan University / Mandarin / Mantality / Mathys and Squire LLP / Maverrik Digital Services Ltd / Medilink North of England / Mercia Ventures / Meta / MetalloBio / Mettryx Ltd / MFL Insurance Group Ltd / MHA Bakertilly Int / MI:RNA / Mind Body Goals / Ministry of Justice / Mishcon de Reya LLP / MoM Incubators / Moonspring AI / Mountside Ventures / My T Bioscience / My Voice AI / Myndtime Ltd / Mysing / Naturbeads Ltd / NatWest Group / Navigator Global at Santander UK Plc / nDreams / Negotia / Neil Dunlop Consulting / Newcastle University / Newcastle upon Tyne Hospitals NHS Foundation Trust / NHS / Nic Redman Voice / NIHR Innovation Observatory / Nisien / Nocode.ai / North East Business Resilience Centre / North East Mayoral Strategic Authority / Northcoders / Northedge / Northern Arc Partners / Northern Gritstone / NP11 / o2h / OAHA / Octopus Investments

WHO SPOKE

Octopus Ventures / Original Version / OS Studios / Oxx / Paisley Red / Palatine Growth Credit / Pangaea Data / Panintelligence / Parallax / PBD Biotech / Peopleplus / PetPact / PHINXT Robotics / Pictura Bio / PinPoint Data Science / PKF Francis Clark / Planet Sport / Plato / Playfair / Plexal / Power For Women / Praetura Group / Pragmatic Semiconductor / Predyktable / PreSeed Now / Present Works / Produmax / ProspHER / PwC / PXN Group / Q5 Partners / Rachel Swann Advisory Ltd / Radar Healthcare / Real McCoy Media Ltd / Rebel Energy / Reclaim Audio / Red Kite Games / Red Line Foundry / Red Lotus Consultancy / Redder Associates / Return On Digital Limited / Revela Health / Rezzil / Rinew Legal / River Capital / RTC North / Safe and Found / Samos Investments / SBWD group / ScaleUp Institute / Scottish Enterprise / Scottish Tech Army / Secerna LLP / Secret Event Service / SeedLegals / Seedrs / Shackletons Ltd / Sheffield Angels / Sheffield Olympic Legacy Park / Shrine London / Sister / Skillfull / Sky Sports / Snowflake Computing / Sony / SoSquared / Sound Leisure / South Yorkshire Mayoral Combined Authority / Space Hub Yorkshire / Spike / Spike Digital / Sponza / Sprout Coaching / Squire Patton Boggs / Squire Patton Boggs LLP / St Oswald's Hospice / Starship Technologies / Start Codon / Stella Insurance Australia / Strength In You / Strength in you Ltd / SuperSeed / Sure Valley Ventures / SVV (Sure Valley Ventures) / SWAI Ltd / tact. / Tanglewood Games / Tanya Arnold Media / Tech for Good Alliance / Tech North Advocates / TECH SY / Techbuyer / Techbuyer Ltd / TenX Ventures / ThatRound Ltd / The Agenda Lounge / The Biskery / The Coders Guild / The Data Refinery / The Engine Room / The Green Techpreneur / The Growth Company / The Portfolio House / The Secret Event Service / The Speakmans / The Tech Bros / The Tech Dept / The Wisdom Studio Ltd / The200bnClub / Theia AI / Thomson Reuters / Tilz Prosperitas Limited / Tred / Tribosonics / Turing Innovation Catalyst / TypeOne Ventures / UBS / UK Research and Innovation / UKBAA / UKRI / ULEMCo / United Autosports / University of Birmingham / University of Huddersfield / University of Leeds / University of Sheffield / Utah Saints / Vampire Digital / VenturePath / Veracity Trust Network / VERSA Studios / Vested / Vet AI / VeUP / WAC / Wainwright Consulting / Walmart Marketplace / We Are Power / West and North / West Yorkshire Combined Authority / West Yorkshire Police / What The Frac? / Wilson Sonsini / Wireless Group / Writebusinessresults / XCD Partners / xDesign / XR Games / Yaba / YFM Equity Partners / YFM Equity Partners LLP / Yorkshire & Humber AHSN / Yoti / YouBee Media Limited / YSYS / Zally / Zero Gravity

IN THEIR WORDS

WHAT PEOPLE SAID ABOUT *CLIMB25*

“As part of Climb, the Combined Authority supported several events supporting young people in our region. It was inspiring and rewarding to see the potential of the next generation of entrepreneurs who are bringing new ideas and innovations to the table and helping them make connections with investment professionals”

Mitchell McCombe, Inclusive Economy Manager for Business Investment, West Yorkshire Combined Authority

“Climb25 was truly magical and it was an absolute pleasure to be involved again this year as a speaker. All the talks and workshops I was part of were authentic, inspirational and thought-provoking, and the networking opportunities offered from the expo area, mixers and VIP drinks sessions, resulted in many meaningful conversations and countless valuable connections gained for myself and ProspHER.”

Serena Fordham, CEO, ProspHER

“The experience exceeded all expectations. The atmosphere was electric, driven by a genuine sense of innovation, collaboration, and ambition that made every moment inspiring. Hosting my panel I was met with insightful questions and the diversity of thought and depth of expertise made for rich, meaningful discussions. Climb25 was more than just a festival - it was a catalyst for growth and a hub of next-generation thinking. I walked away with new ideas, valuable contacts, and a renewed excitement for investing in the future of AI and technology. I look forward to seeing what's next at Climb26!”

Caroline Cartellieri, Director, C-Squared Consulting

“Climb is a MUST attend event! One of the best networking events in the UK for global business. The variety of panel talks, interactive sessions, pop-up stands provides a unique way to engage, learn and hear all things business! [...] on the back of Climb we were able to secure grants & business support from national (Innovate UK) / local (WYCA) government. Climb offers a unique experience to be able to meet with global leaders from all sectors. At Climb, you never know who you might get connected with...”

Angus Young, Founder, Net-Zu

IN THEIR WORDS

WHAT PEOPLE SAID ABOUT *CLIMB24*

Speakers, exhibitors and guests on Climb24 in Leeds, quoted word for word from what they shared afterwards.

"Blue skies, fast cars, great speakers and an awesome venue - really enjoying meeting new and old contacts"

Peter Hindle-Marsh, IDS Group

"Really insightful day at #Climb24 with lots of powerful speakers"

Rachel Fowler, Professional Services, Lloyds Bank

"ClimbUK 24 is one of those events that "Just Works" the energy around the place and the sheer number of people doing amazing things in once place gave the whole day a unique and exciting atmosphere that was infectious."

Mark Walsh, CEO, KwizzBit

"The event was packed with insightful panels. I particularly enjoyed the talks at the Innovate UK Creative booth, hearing from other creative businesses about how they're effectively utilising their grant funding was super motivating"

Bekah Chapman

"what a great day filled with new and renewed connections, inspirational speakers, and fantastic businesses. Connecting with investors and potential partners who believe in our vision. The future is bright for businesses in West Yorkshire!"

Shashank Saini

"Amazing round tables, very insightful speakers and many lovely catch-ups with friends, partners and clients. And meeting some incredible humans building wonderful businesses. The best business event this year so far"

Johnny J Pawlik, CEO, Mantra Media Ltd

"A day of feeling inspired and educated by so many founders, investors and brilliant people and organisations! Such a great job Gordon Bateman. Pilar Rubio and all the team! Great to see so many familiar faces and friends, too many to mention!"

Richard Paxman OBE, Paxman Scalp Cooling

"A brilliant day, connecting with brands and thought leaders within their relative fields. It's great to see that the north of England is getting recognised for its talent and business opportunities."

Christian Philip Mercer-Hall, Positive Plus One

"Had the most AMAZING 1st day ClimbUK event! Met some wonderful people and enjoyed every minute of hosting the impact zone!"

Paula Chamberlain, The Crescent & Co

"It was a fantastic opportunity to celebrate innovative ideas, network with businesses and investors, and be a part of an ecosystem that encourages big thinking and supports you to make it happen."

Tanweer Hassan, Co-Founder, Newway Biotech

CLIMB24 *SPEAKERS*

Everyone who spoke at Climb24, with their organisation.

Aaron Holt Holdson / **Abigail Marshall Katung** Leeds City Council / **Adam Mitcheson** APM / **Adam Pacifico** Heidrick & Struggles / **Adam Roney** Calls9 / **Agnes Wamagui** Innovate UK KTN / **Alban Tramard** Zally / **Alex Bell** BJSS / **Alex La Via** Life More Offline / **Alexander Hall** Alexander Bell CO / **Alfredo Ramos** High Value Manufacturing Catapult / **Alistair Forbes** Scottish Tech Army / **Ammar Mirza** AmmarM Group / **Amy Cockram** AND Digital / **Anders Reeves** CovertSwarm / **Andrew Bishop** Reclaim Audio / **Andrew Hodgson** Innovation SuperNetwork / **Andrew Jenkins** Strength In You / **Andrew Round** DeepBridge / **Andrew White** Mathys and Squire LLP / **Andy Etches** Rezzil / **Andy Naylor** Northern Gritstone / **Andy Roberts** Digital Sport North / **Anishka Prasad** Juniper Place / **Anjum Sharief** Mishcon de Reya LLP / **Anna France** University of Leeds / **Anna Heyes** Active Profile / **Anna Roughley** Squire Patton Boggs / **Anna Sutton** The Data Refinery / **Anthony Rose** SeedLegals / **Anthony Ullman** Shackletons Ltd / **Arun Aggarwal** Lloyds Banking Group / **Asma Iqbal** Chadwick Lawrence LLP / **Ayan Mohamed** Digital Oasis / **Ben Still** West Yorkshire Combined Authority / **Bobby Thandi** XR Games / **Bruce Hydes** VeUP / **Caner Veli** Kind Community / **Cate Poulson** Excelerator Partners / **Catherine Thristan** University of Leeds / **Chandrima Ganguly** Lloyds / **Charlene Lyons** Lyons Consultancy / **Charlotte Scott** Innovation SuperNetwork / **Chris Black** Sound Leisure / **Chris Danks** Innovate UK / **Christian Tooley** i3 investing / **Christopher Neave** Make It Wild / **Clare Hayward** NP11 / **Claudine Reid** Lloyds Banking Group / **Cliff Prior** GSG / **Colette Safhill** GoatDrinks / **Dan Bowyer** SuperSeed / **Dan Kirby** The Tech Dept / **Danei Jamieson** Biorelate / **Daniil Chen** TypeOne Ventures / **Dave Tucker** Glean / **David Cameron** Aivantor / **David Hall** YFM Equity Partners / **David Levine** Manchester Angels / **David Naylor** Squire Patton Boggs LLP / **DC Cahalane** Sure Valley Ventures / **Dianna Chrouch** Chrouch Consulting / **Dominic McGregor** Fearless Adventures / **Donna Meierdiercks** Alexander Whitley Dance Company

IN THEIR WORDS

WHAT PEOPLE SAID ABOUT *CLIMB24*

“What an inspiring day! Bringing together so many businesses and potential investors from around the globe, to supercharge growth, really created a buzz, and showcased the opportunity and talent that West Yorkshire has.”

Mandy Ridyard, Chief Business Advisor to the Mayor of West Yorkshire

“Great opportunity to connect with people, and gain new insights and inspiration.”

Harpreet Kaur, Capital Enterprise

“The event had such a fantastic atmosphere of excitement, collaboration and support, and it was a real opportunity to meet people and share ideas from across so many sectors.”

Nina Hinton, Director of Business and Development, Videosign

“It was an absolute driving force of inspiration for those of us based in Lancashire. You can really feel that same energy and buzz at ClimbUK 2024. Collaboration, community and innovation showing its great impact in the North”

Tom W

“Over the past few days we have had the opportunity to connect with some incredible entrepeneurs & catch up with our beloved tech community ... on our doorstep in Leeds!”

Elly Nettleton, Co-Founder, Boost

“I spoke to some fantastic individuals and learnt more about navigating the business and investment landscape.”

Katie Fradley, Director of Product Development, Flowlio

“A fantastic chance to celebrate innovative ideas, network with businesses and investors, and be a part of an ecosystem that encourages big thinking and supports you to make it happen.”

Shanya Sachdeva, Shanya's Staffing Ltd

“Attending ClimbUK's Climb24 in Leeds was such a valuable experience [...] It was a pleasure to meet a great bunch of successful and creative people all in one place.”

Vaishnavi Balaji, Data Scientist, Curenetics

“What's the best event you've ever been to? Mine might have to be ClimbUK! The power of attending impactful events like this can be truly transformative, giving you the reset your mind might need. Not only does going to an event make you disconnect physically from the office and digitally from your computer, allowing you to feel present; but the learning opportunities and the new relationships that are forged are so so so valuable.”

Ash Wilks, Director of Business Development, Wallbreaker

WHO SPOKE

Doris Zhang Envestors / **Dragos Popa** Plato / **Dwain Reid** Kingston University / **Ed Cowburn** Acid FC / **Eleanor Temple** Kings Chambers / **Emily Fitch-Deeley** Seedrs / **Emily Nott** Innovate UK / **Evan Maindonald** Hyperlight Ventures / **Felix Kumi-Ampofo** West Yorkshire Combined Authority / **Fiona Dent** Edge / **Fraser Lusty** Equity Gap / **Gary Crotaz** 100 Coaches Agency / **Geeta Nathan** Innovate UK / **George Mensah** Sure Valley Ventures / **Georgia Halston** Halston / **Georgia Kirke** Writebusinessresults / **Georgina Fairhall** WAC / **Gina Jackson** Skillfull / **Glenn Fletcher** Tribosonics / **Hannah Jeffreys** Lloyds Banking Group / **Hannah Mills** NHS / **Hannah Williamson** Edge VC / **Harriet Hole** Innovate UK Business Connect / **Harry Morgan** 7 Percent Ventures / **Harry Panter** Housr / **Helen Oldham** Lifted Ventures / **Howard Hall** DTP Group / **Hugo Heppell** Channel 4 / **Ian McAleese** Snowflake Computing / **Irene Graham** ScaleUp Institute / **Jack Brandwood** tact. / **Jake Zim** Sony / **James Hales** Northedge / **James Hall** Parallax / **James Mason** West and North / **James Sutherland** Autonomo Technologies / **Jamie Akhtar** CyberSmart / **Jamie Sefton** Game Republic / **Jane Bototh** UBS / **Jane Theaker** PBD Biotech / **Jess Sewter** Generation UK & Ireland / **Jessica McCreadie** Northern Gritstone / **Jessica Moffatt-Owen** Plexal / **Jessica Wenmouth** Lancaster University / **Joely Irlam** PBD Biotech / **John Eaglesman** Advance Digital Innovation / **Jonathan Crook** Department for Business and Trade / **Jonathan Lloyd** CGHero / **Jonathan Pryor** Leeds City Council / **Jordan Dargue** Lifted Ventures / **Judith Parry** Lifted Ventures / **Kalam Neale** British Esports Federation / **Karl Oxford** Lloyds Bank / **Kat Burdett** Techbuyer Ltd / **Keeley Crockett** Manchester Metropolitan University / **Kelvin Shek** Space Hub Yorkshire / **Kerry Sharp** Scottish Enterprise / **Kimberley Abbott** Vested / **Kirsty McIntosh** Tech for Good Alliance / **Kumi Thiruchelvam** My Voice AI / **Laura Harper** Lewis Silkin / **Lee Chambers** Male Allies UK / **Leke Shoulade** Black Valley / **Liam Wright** Exodus Technologies / **Lisa Johnson** Starship Technologies / **Liz Scott** Turing Innovation Catalyst / **Liz Shaw** Peopleplus / **Lizzie Withington** Newcastle University / **Louis Georgiou** Code Computerlove / **Luca Budello** Innovate UK KTN / **Lucinda Coleman** PKF Francis Clark / **Lucy Hall** LOANHOOD

IN THEIR WORDS

WHAT PEOPLE SAID ABOUT *CLIMB24*

"the best bit has been meeting some brilliant businesses and seeing how much they got from being part of #Climb24"

Lorna Holroyd, Strategic Lead (Business Investment), West Yorkshire Combined Authority

"Seeing young founders making great headways into the business world with ideas dreamt up in bedrooms was very inspiring."

Dan Boys, Founder, Wildfi Ltd

"This event is only going to grow even bigger and better. If you found #Climb24 valuable, I highly recommend rebooking early for #Climb25, especially if you plan to exhibit."

Tas Hadjisavva, Founder, Clubit Group

"Met old friends, connected to lots of new people and I look forward to collaborating. A fantastic event and look forward to attending again next year."

Daniel Usifoh

"Plenty of very insightful workshops, roundtables and panel sessions from a great selection of speakers [...] we had an absolute blast. Looking forward to Climb25 already!"

Matt Wheeler, Director, madeby.studio

"My first visit to ClimbUK this week, and it really hit home why I love working with businesses in tech so much [...] Maybe it was the sun making an appearance in Leeds, but it definitely feels like there's good energy and momentum coming back to the tech sector"

Kelly Gilmour-Grassam, Making You Content

"Absolutely amazing couple of days at ClimbUK 24 some amazing technology and innovative companies [...] I would highly recommend visiting Climb 2025 next year"

Chris Eastwood, Co-Founder and Director, The Rybec Group

"I made so many wonderful connections and learnt so much from the many events and speakers at this awesome innovation, industry and investment festival. There is so much power in hearing other people's stories."

Britta Ofori-Kuragu

"Excellent couple of days up in Leeds at this year's ClimbUK. A truly vibrant, friendly and welcoming community. Lots of excellent discussions around the innovation and investment landscape in the North of England, investment trends in the UK, and what we can do to foster more collaboration and meaningful connections to improve and grow the tech and life sciences ecosystem in that region. Really enjoyed catching up with clients, colleagues and contacts and met some fantastic entrepreneurs, investors and connectors. Lots to think about and am totally exhausted, but really pleased to have been a part of this event."

Zickie Lim, Partner, Head of VC Investments, Mills & Reeve LLP

WHO SPOKE

Lucy Smith Fawkes Digital / **Luke Crook** Innovate UK / **Mandy Ridyard** Produmax / **Marcus Stuttard** London Stock Exchange Group / **Marie Labus** AMLo Biosciences / **Mark Holmes** Planet Sport / **Mark Roberts** Red Line Foundry / **Mark Scott** Bella & Duke / **Martin Bryant** PreSeed Now / **Martin Sutton** River Capital / **Matt Ward** XCD Partners / **Matt Wheeler** madeby.studio / **Mel Ellyard** Innovate UK KTN / **Michael Dimelow** Bloc Ventures / **Michael Murray** MetalloBio / **Morayo Fagborun-Bennett** Ministry of Justice / **Naomi Timperley** Tech North Advocates / **Nigel Walker** Innovate UK / **Nikita Thakrar** Included VC / **Nikki Foster** Spike / **Patrick Smith** Zally / **Patrick Wain** Yoti / **Paul Anthony Williams** Ittybit / **Paul Gadd** Innovate UK / **Paul Greer** VERSA Studios / **Peter Baxendale** Negotia / **Peter Hopton** Paisley Red / **Phil Eaves** Spike / **Phil Steele** GoJoe / **Phillip Sewell** Predyktable / **Phoebe Sleet** Digital Poverty Alliance / **Rachel Lyske** DAACI / **Raquel Da Silva** Innovate UK / **Rich Williams** Wireless Group / **Richard Tunstall** University of Leeds / **Richelle Schuster** CREATICITY / **Robert Greenwood** British Patient Capital / **Robert Leishman** PwC / **Rod Beer** UKBAA / **Sam Taylor** GreenTech Gathering / **Sam Thomas** SoSquared / **Samia Nefti-Meziani** University of Birmingham / **Sarita Stefani** Amilis / **Scott O'Brien** UKRI / **Sharon Jandu** Yaba / **Sherin Mathew** AI Tech UK / **Sim Singh-Landa** Praetura Group / **Simon Bax** Captur / **Simon Hall** APIMS Limited / **Simon Iwaniszak** Red Kite Games / **Sophie Lee** Electric Peach / **Steph Taylor** Leeds Community Foundation / **Stephen Harris** Lloyds Banking Group / **Steve Leach** North East Business Resilience Centre / **Steven Hubbard** Predyktable / **Stevie Ward** Mantality / **Stewart Boutcher** Veracity Trust Network / **Suzane Coles** Innovate UK / **Tamsin O'Luanaigh** nDreams / **Tanya Arnold** BBC / **Thuria Wenbar** Evaro / **Tim Vaesen** United Autosports / **Toby Lywood** Oxx / **Tom Nelson** Spike Digital / **Tom Riordan** Leeds City Council / **Tony Capper** Brightsolid / **Tony Mallett** Inspirational Leads / **Tracy Brabin** West Yorkshire Combined Authority / **Vibhor Gupta** Pangaea Data / **Victoria Garcia** BindEthics and Quick Labs / **Vikki Sly** Coincover / **Wendy Tsai** Space Hub Yorkshire / **Will Turner** GoJoe / **Yanwen Chen** PHINXT Robotics / **Yvonne Nagawa** Black Seed / **Zandra Moore** Panintelligence / **Zsike Peter** Vampire Digital

IN THEIR WORDS

WHAT PEOPLE SAID ABOUT *CLIMB24*

"Bloody brilliant couple of days at ClimbUK with Conor Walsh. I don't think I've been to an event which has been as genuinely useful to our business before."

Paul White, Founder, Patch App UK

"I met a TONNE of inspiring founders [...] It's clear to see leeds is an exciting place to be right now."

Harry Baker, Barclays Eagle Labs

"Met so many lovely new people, learnt a lot [...] It's so great to get out there and expand my network and meet so many ace people!"

Nick Wilmshurst

"What a brilliant event and great for Leeds and the wider region to be having an event of this quality, it is the efforts of Gordon Bateman and the wider ecosystem that is helping put Yorkshire on the map for tech. I was blown away by the event generally and made some great connections with new contacts and some of the key players in this region."

Paul Johnson, Mills & Reeve LLP

"It was a great day in Leeds and you could tell that so much work was put on to make the festival a memorable one. Looking forward to #Climb25"

Stefania Amankwah-tia

"Just to add to your feed already absolutely overflowing with praise for the ClimbUK Climb24 festival over the last couple of days. It really was a fantastic event put on by Gordon Bateman and his team. Everyone I spoke to was blown away by the calibre of delegates and speakers. Great to catch up with people I already know, make some new connections, and get involved in some really interesting and inspiring conversations."

Oliver King, Mills & Reeve LLP

"what a day! #Climb24 brought UK top investors, startups and scaleups together to showcase global opportunity in the North of England"

Richard Tunstall, University of Leeds

"Throughout the day, I had inspiring conversations with so many people and innovative businesses. [...] buzzing with energy, open, honest conversations, and laughter"

Madeleine France, Founder, Blossom Training and Development CIC

"Climb24 was really good - surpassed my expectations [...] Met some really nice people doing fascinating things - made some good connections and attended some really thought provoking talks. Looking forward to Climb25."

Paul Boardman, Consultant, Helmcrag

"another knock-out innovation event for the region!"

Adam Roney, Founder and CEO, Calls9

IN THEIR WORDS

WHAT PEOPLE SAID ABOUT *CLIMB24*

"there's always someone eager to lend a hand, which is why events like Climb are so invaluable. A heartfelt thank you to the organisers and all the wonderful new faces we had the pleasure of meeting, each engaged in remarkable endeavours and providing outstanding support."

Franek Siejek

"It was a jam-packed couple of days listening to some great minds talk about interesting topics and meeting some new connections."

Poppy Collier, Social Media Manager and Content Creator

"There was a huge focus on building ecosystems which support entrepreneurship, with collaboration at their core. And how accessible and clearly signposted support must be for business owners, making it easy to access market, funding and talent (as opposed to sharing a list of topics or content and asking them to find the right place to start)"

Talitha Heaton, MPA Group

"The calibre of attendees was top-notch! [...] the north knows how to do it!"

Eddy Davies, Founder and CEO, mutuals

"it was genuinely invigorating to have so many great conversations with investors, founders, enterprise agencies, government, ecosystem builders from across the UK and globally"

Barry McDonald, VP Community, CodeBase

"The event was amazing, amazing workshop and speakers! Thank you for inviting me to be part of such a great conference! Roll on Climb 25!!"

Andrew Jenkins, Strength In You

"This was one of the best events I have exhibited at. An amazing team, speakers and delegates. Thanks for creating such a wonderful and professional experience for all"

Tim Bennett, Founder, Powerhouse Digital Limited

"Great event, great speakers, great participants, great networking, great engagement. Just altogether great!"

Ian McAleese, International HR Leader, Snowflake Computing

"Climb24 was a revelation! It was a really good event-well organised, well attended (with a high proportion of business attendees), some high quality speakers and panel discussions. I attended as a delegate as I was unsure of the value. but having experienced it, I would give it a strong recommendation."

Simon Hall, Oxford Innovation Advice

ON STAGE AT CLIMB23

CLIMB23 *SESSIONS*

Some of the talks, panels and workshops on the Climb23 agenda.

Breaking the Glass Ceiling / Building a Pipeline of Talent / Carbon Neutral Contracting: Opportunities for SMEs in Government Procurement / Cognitive Diversity: Fuelling Innovation and Driving Growth / ESG - Actions speak louder than words / From Idea to Impact: Building a successful Impact Business / Funding an early stage life sciences business / Gameopolis x Game Republic / How Elite Sport Mindset Fuels Entrepreneurial Success / How VR is changing the sports sector / Investing in Games and VR from Seed to Exit / Investing in mental health: Where are the opportunities for growth and impact / Investing in the future of consumer healthcare / John Gleasure - Sport, Media and OTT / Maximising fan engagement in live sport / Opportunities for Cleantech and Sustainable Innovation / Taking a Business Through Various Stages of Investment / The Anatomy of High Performing Teams: Key Elements for Success / The Power of Diversity and Inclusion: Building a Multicultural and Multigenerational Talent Pool / Trash is a Pain in the Cash / Unlocked - Purpose Driven Leadership / Big data in healthcare: leveraging analytics and AI to improve patient outcomes

IN THEIR WORDS

WHAT PEOPLE SAID ABOUT *CLIMB23*

"You and the team have exceeded all my (already sky-high) expectations for Climb23! Cannot wait for next year!"

Gary Crotaz, Climb23 speaker

"...A FANTASTIC EVENT! GREAT IDEAS, GREAT PEOPLE, GREAT VENUE."

Jennifer Byrne, Former CTO, Microsoft

WHO SPOKE

CLIMB23 *SPEAKERS*

Everyone who spoke at Climb23, with their organisation where we hold it.

Abbie Morris Compare Ethics / **Abigail Marshall Katung** Leeds City Council / **Adam Schoff** Actmediaventures / **Adrien Carta** Kalank / **Alan Rhees-Cooper** West Yorkshire Police / **Alex Batchelor** Pictura Bio / **Alison Lowe** West Yorkshire Combined Authority / **Amanda Lyne** ULEMCo / **Amardeep Sirha** AmarTi / **Andrew Sheffield** Playfair / **Andy Etches** Albion VC / **Andy Moss** Cube International / **Anil Glendinning** Friday Sundae / **Anna Ashford** Alt Legal / **Anna Sutton** The Data Refinery / **Annette Joseph** Diverse & Equal / **Axay Soni** o2h / **Becca Stenson** Secret Event Service / **Ben Hinchcliffe** Just Add Water / **Bobby Thandi** XR Games / **Bolu Fagborun** Fagborun Limited / **Brenda Riley** / **Charlie Hedges** Charlie Hedges Advisory / **Check Warner** Ada Ventures / **Chris Carey** LIVE / **Chris Cheshire** Safe and Found / **Chris Elphick** BVCA / **Chris Low** Sheffield Olympic Legacy Park / **Chris Quickfall** Cognassist / **Chris Wood** Tanglewood Games / **Christine King** / **Claire Hamlin** Q5 Partners / **Cleveland Henry** Leeds Community Foundation / **Cliff Prior** GSG / **Cole Walton** Northcoders / **Daniel Kirby** / **Daniel Rooke** Start Codon / **Dash Tabor** / **Dave Foreman** / **Dave Tucker** Genio / **David Dixon** Future Greens / **Ed Abis** Dizplai / **Elanor Harry** HACE / **Ellis Hall** Achilles Information / **Emma Sinclair** EnterpriseAlumni / **Eva Speakman** The Speakmans / **Eve Roodhouse** Leeds City Council / **Fabien Rolland** Losonnante / **Fiona Bolam** Leeds City Council / **Fiona Ras-Jones** Make Impact / **Gary Crotaz** Fleckerl Ventures / **Gemma McCall** Culture Shift / **Georgia Halston** / **Georgia Kirke** Writebusinessresults / **Giles Moore** / **Griselda Togobo** Goal Achieve Planner / **Helen Crampin** UK Research and Innovation / **Iain Edwards** RTC North / **Ian Fishwick** Carbon Net Zero Industry Working Group / **Ian O'Donnell**

WHO SPOKE

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